- *Synchronous decoupling*—We can now be at different places, but we still have to find a common time (3 p.m.) and find each other (exchange Skype IDs, for instance).
- *Asynchronous decoupling*—We can be at different places and now also don't have to find a common time. We only have to find each other (exchange email addresses).

A meeting isn't the only thing that can be decoupled. In software systems, you can find a lot of tightly coupled components, such as the following:

- A public IP address is like the location of our meeting: to make a request to a web server, you must know its public IP address, and the virtual machine must be connected to that address. If you want to change the public IP address, both parties are involved in making the appropriate changes. The public IP address is tightly coupled with the web server.
- If you want to make a request to a web server, the web server must be online at the same time. Otherwise, your request will be rejected. A web server can be offline for many reasons: someone might be installing updates, a hardware failure, and so on. The client is tightly coupled with the web server.

AWS offers solutions for synchronous and asynchronous decoupling. Typically, synchronous decoupling is used when the client expects an immediate response. For example, a user expects an response to the request to load the HTML of a website with very little latency. The Elastic Load Balancing (ELB) service provides different types of load balancers that sit between your web servers and the client to decouple your requests synchronously. The client sends a request to the ELB, and the ELB forwards the request to a virtual machine or